

Javier Tibau

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SUMMARY

UX Researcher with 10+ years leading end-to-end human-centered research across complex socio-technical systems. Designed and executed a 3-year longitudinal field study deploying custom hardware and software in 12 households across multiple countries, translating qualitative and quantitative findings into iterative product redesigns. Peer-reviewed and published.

EXPERIENCE

UX Researcher & System Designer (Ph.D.)

2014 — 2019

Virginia Tech

Blacksburg, Virginia

- Designed and led a 3-year longitudinal field study with 6 families (12 households, 2 countries), deploying custom networked devices in homes to study how shared music supports remote family connection.
- Translated qualitative findings into actionable design insights through thematic analysis, driving 3 major prototype iterations—from screen-based interface to tangible NFC cards that enabled even toddlers to initiate music sharing across households.
- Identified that passive shared music experiences—not synchronous conversation—drove the richest family interactions, reframing the project's design direction and informing a shift from real-time coordination to ambient connection.
- Engineered and deployed networked Raspberry Pi music boxes (Python, Node.js, WebSockets, Docker) that ran unattended in families' homes for months, generating continuous behavioral data in naturalistic settings.

Associate Professor of Computer Science

2011 — 2024

Escuela Superior Politécnica del Litoral (ESPOL)

Guayaquil, Ecuador

- Mentored 35+ students per semester through user research, prototyping, and usability evaluation in cross-functional project teams across HCI and Game Design courses.
- Led a multi-year program evaluation involving external reviewers, faculty coordination, and institutional leadership, resulting in Ecuador's first international accreditation in Computer Science.
- Scoped, budgeted, and negotiated a \$200K VR/AR laboratory acquisition including multi-projector systems, motion capture, and rapid prototyping equipment.

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Computer Science

2019

Virginia Tech | Fulbright Scholarship

Blacksburg, Virginia

M.Sc. in Computer Science

2010

Universitat Politècnica de Catalunya

Barcelona, Spain

B.Sc. in Computer Science

2009

Escuela Superior Politécnica del Litoral

Guayaquil, Ecuador

SKILLS

Research: Longitudinal field studies, in-home deployments, semi-structured interviews, diary studies, usability testing, survey design, thematic analysis, mixed-methods research, interaction design, prototyping.

Technical: Python, JavaScript/Node.js, HTML/CSS, Docker, Linux, Raspberry Pi, NFC/RFID, Git.

Languages: English, Spanish (native), French, Catalan.